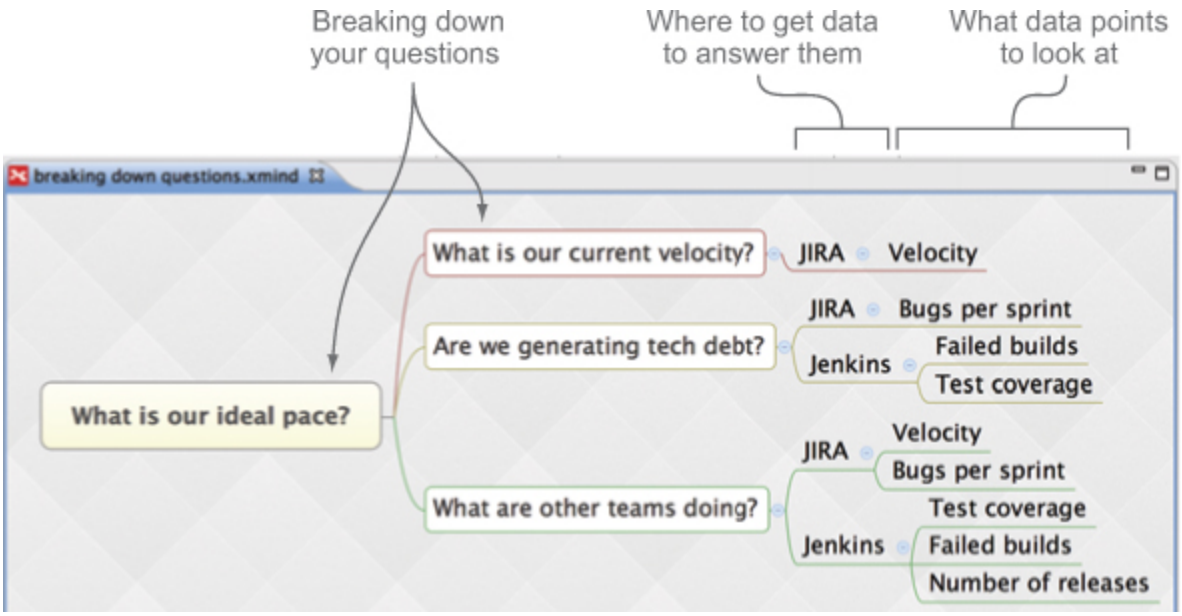
Mind mapping is a brainstorming technique where you start with an idea and then keep deconstructing it until it's broken down into small elements. If you're not familiar with mind mapping, a great tool to start with is XMind (www.xmind.net/), a powerful and free (for the basic version) tool that makes mind mapping pretty simple.

If you take a simple example, "What is our ideal pace?" you can break that down into smaller questions:

- What is our current velocity?
- Are we generating tech debt?
- What are other teams in the company doing?

From there you could break those questions down into smaller ones, or you can start identifying places where you can get that data. An example mind map is shown in figure 1.11.

Figure 1.11. Breaking down questions with XMind



Thinking a project through, mapping, and defining your questions give you a place to start collecting the type of data you need to define your metrics.

1.4.2. Visualizing your data